

ART ▼

CATCH THEM YOUNG

Delhi's **Dhoomimal Gallery** is spotlighting 60 emerging artists through the Ravi Jain Memorial Foundation Exhibition

NEW COLOURS
Paintings on display at the Ravi Jain Memorial Exhibition at the Dhoomimal Art Gallery

Thirty-four years ago, Dhoomimal, one of India's oldest art galleries, started an initiative to champion young artists through an annual exhibition and awards. The late gallerist Ravi Jain, after whom they are named, believed that the art movement could only thrive with an ongoing infusion of fresh talent. Under the stewardship of his son Uday Jain, director of Dhoomimal Gallery, the initiative continues to foster new talent each year. "The exhibition and the awards carry forward my father's vision of nurturing talent and building a vibrant ecosystem for art in India. Every year, we receive over 600 entries from across India, reflecting the rich diversity of contemporary art through paintings, printmaking, sculptures, video installations and digital creations," says Jain.

This year, the exhibition has a total of 120 artworks on display, two each by the 60 shortlisted artists. On October 14, four of the exhibiting artists will be selected as the winners of the 34th Annual Ravi Jain Memorial Foundation Awards by a distinguished panel comprising contemporary artist Vibha Galhotra, painter Rekha Rodwittiya, curator and cultural commentator Anish Gawande, artist Arunkumar H.G. and art curator Ina Puri. ■

—Amit Dixit

The 34th Annual Ravi Jain Memorial Foundation Exhibition is on at Dhoomimal Gallery, G-42, Outer Circle, Connaught Place, New Delhi, till Oct. 15

ART ▼

PARALLEL VISIONS

A new showcase honours Ratan Parimoo and Naina Dalal's role in Indian modernism



JUST ONE CHANCE
Naina Dalal's 'Ma Mujhe Jine Do' (2006), in line with her protagonists who struggle but remain resilient

Mumbai's National Gallery of Modern Art (NGMA) is showcasing the works of senior artists and life partners, Ratan Parimoo and Naina Dalal. The retrospectives—curated by Girish Shahane—span over six decades of practice and highlight their contributions to Indian modernism through Parimoo's abstractions and Dalal's explorations of women's lives.

Ratan Parimoo: Pioneer Abstractionist revisits the veteran painter's works from 1958 to 1973. With over 40 paintings, drawings and prints, the exhibition highlights his early line work inspired by Jain and Egyptian art, his move into gestural abstraction and his constant experimentation. As a co-founder of the Baroda Group of Artists, Parimoo shaped an artistic climate that turned Baroda into one of India's most dynamic centres of art. "At Baroda, I was encouraged to try modern Western techniques such as cubism, pointillism and abstraction," Parimoo recalls. Born in Srinagar in 1936, Parimoo's work remained relatively unrecognised despite having been exhibited throughout the 1960s and 1970s. Honoured with a Padma Shri in January, he says, "Looking back on all those years of struggle and hard work, I feel encouraged. Even now, I paint and research, as creativity remains a lifelong preoccupation."

Running alongside is *Naina Dalal: The Silent Fire Within*, a retrospective of over 150 drawings, paintings and prints by one of India's pioneering artists. Born in 1935 in Vadodara, Dalal trained at the Faculty of Fine Arts, Baroda, and later in London and New York. She mastered etching, aquatint, collagraphy and lithography, pushing technical boundaries while infusing her works with a quiet intensity. "I created art to give voice to my thoughts, emotions and identity. The title rightly captures the angst within me and the characters in my art," says Dalal. Not surprisingly, her protagonists are women whose lives are often marked by struggle, but also by indomitable resilience. ■

—Prachi Joshi

The exhibitions are on till Oct. 12